

Brian Libgober

Department of Political Science
Northwestern University

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EDUCATION

- Ph.D.** Harvard University, Government, 2018
Dissertation Committee: Daniel Carpenter (Chair), Kenneth Shepsle, Jon Rogowski
- M.A.** Harvard University, Statistics, 2017
- J.D.** University of Michigan Law School, *cum laude*, 2015
Dean's Scholarship
- B.A.** University of Chicago, Mathematics and Philosophy, *with honors*, 2010
Viola Bower Award, full-tuition scholarship

APPOINTMENTS

- 2022– Northwestern University
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science
Assistant Professor, Pritzker School of Law
Faculty Fellow, Institute for Policy Research
- 2022– Yale Law School
Senior Research Scholar
- 2025–2026 Princeton University
Visiting Research Scholar, School of Public and International Affairs
Fellow, Center for the Study of Democratic Politics
- 2020–2022 University of California, San Diego
Assistant Professor, School of Global Policy and Strategy
- 2018–2020 Yale University
Postdoctoral Associate, Department of Political Science

RESEARCH INTERESTS

American Politics, Political Institutions, Executive Branch Politics, Lobbying, Special Interests, Political Economy, Public Policy, Law and Politics

PUBLICATIONS

BOOK PROJECT

White Shoes, Hidden Hands: Lawyers, Lobbying, and the Administrative State.

ARTICLES IN PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

15. Pashley, Nicole, Brian Libgober, and Tirthankar Dasgupta. “Analysis and Sample-Size Determination for 2K Audit Experiments with Binary Response and Application to

- Identification of Effect of Racial Discrimination on Access to Justice.” *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series a*, ahead of print, 2026. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2503.10591>. (Forthcoming)
14. Holverscheid, Arne, Brian Libgober, and Guillaume Pouliot. “The Persuasive Effect of Televised Campaign Advertising in the 2016 Presidential Election.” *Research & Politics*, 2026. (Accepted)
 13. Fernandes, Ivan Filipe, Gustavo Andrey De Almeida Lopes Fernandes, Michael Touchton, and Brian Libgober. “Beyond Partisan Rhetoric: Institutional Constraints and Local COVID-19 Policies in Brazil.” *Social Science & Medicine* 385 (November 2025): 118607. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2025.118607>.
 12. Omari, Aymane, Nasser Alansari, Brian Libgober, and Aaron R. Kaufman. “A Comprehensive Dataset of United States Federal Procurement from 1979 to 2023.” *Scientific Data* 12, no. 1 (2025): 1368. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-025-05714-1>.
 11. Libgober, Brian, and Connor T. Jerzak. “Linking Datasets on Organizations Using Half a Billion Open-Collaborated Records.” *Political Science Research and Methods* 13, no. 4 (2025): 923–42. <https://doi.org/10.1017/psrm.2024.55>.
 10. Libgober, Brian, and Daniel Carpenter. “Lawyers as Lobbyists: Regulatory Advocacy in American Finance.” *Perspectives on Politics* 22, no. 4 (2024): 1045–64. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1537592723002943>.
 9. Chen, Benjamin Minhao, and Brian Libgober. “Do Administrative Procedures Fix Cognitive Biases?.” *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory* 34, no. 1 (2024): 105–21. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/muac054>.
 8. Libgober, Brian. “A Comprehensive Dataset of U.S. Federal Laws (1789–2022).” *Scientific Data* 11, no. 1 (2024): 16. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-023-02758-z>.
 7. Ravichandran, Arun, Nicole E. Pashley, Brian Libgober, and Tirthankar Dasgupta. “Optimal Allocation of Sample Size for Randomization-Based Inference from 2K Factorial Designs.” *Journal of Causal Inference* 12, no. 1 (2024): 20230046. <https://doi.org/10.1515/jci-2023-0046>.
 6. Libgober, Brian, and Steven Rashin. “What Public Comments During Rulemaking Do (And Why).” *American Politics Research* 51, no. 6 (2023): 715–30. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1532673X231175686>.
 5. Abi-Hassan, Sahar, Janet M. Box-Steffensmeier, Dino P. Christenson, Aaron R. Kaufman, and Brian Libgober. “The Ideologies of Organized Interests and Amicus Curiae Briefs: Large-scale, Social Network Imputation of Ideal Points.” *Political Analysis*, no. 3 (2023): 396–413. <https://doi.org/10.1017/pan.2022.34>.
 4. Libgober, Brian, and Mark D. Richardson. “Identifying Bureaus with Substantial Personnel Change during the Trump Administration: A Bayesian Approach.” *Plos One* 18, no. 1 (2023): e278458. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0278458>.
 3. Libgober, Brian. “Strategic Proposals, Endogenous Comments, And Bias in Rulemaking.” *The Journal of Politics* 82, no. 2 (2020): 642–56. <https://doi.org/10.1086/706891>.
 2. Libgober, Brian. “Meetings, Comments, And the Distributive Politics of Rulemaking.” *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 15, no. 4 (2020): 449–81. <https://doi.org/10.1561/100.00018135>.
 1. Carpenter, Daniel P., Devin Judge-Lord, Brian Libgober, and Steven Rashin. “Data and Methods for Analyzing Special Interest Influence in Rulemaking.” *Interest Groups & Advocacy* 9, no. 3 (2020): 425–35. <https://doi.org/10.1057/s41309-020-00094-w>.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Libgober, Brian. “Policy and Politics of Payment Systems.” In *Picking Winners: Citizenship, Central Banks, And Consumer Finance*, edited by Lawrence R Jacobs and Desmond King, *Picking Winners: Citizenship, Central Banks, And Consumer Finance*. Oxford University Press, 2026. <https://doi.org/10.1093/9780197831823.003.0004>.

Libgober, Brian. “Race and the Political Economy of Civil Justice.” In *Rethinking the Lawyers' Monopoly*, 1st ed., edited by David Freeman Engstrom and Nora Freeman Engstrom, *Rethinking the Lawyers' Monopoly*. Cambridge University Press, 2025. <https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009528535.004>.

Carpenter, Daniel P., and Brian Libgober. “Administrative Politics with Clear Stakes and Venues: Strategic Commenting Upon Federal Reserve Debit Card Regulations.” In *Accountability Reconsidered: Voters, Interests, And Information in US Policymaking, Accountability Reconsidered: Voters, Interests, And Information in US Policymaking*. Cambridge University Press, 2023.

Libgober, Brian. “Getting a Lawyer While Black: A Field Experiment.” *Lewis & Clark Law Review* 24, no. 1 (2020): 53–108. <https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.3389279>.

Carpenter, Daniel P., and Brian Libgober. “Lobbying the Rulemakers with Lawyers: Reflections from the Volcker Rule.” *Extensions*, no. Summer (2018).

Libgober, Brian. “Can the EU Be a Constitutional System Without Universal Access to Judicial Review?.” *Michigan Journal of International Law* 36, no. 2 (2015): 353.

WORKING PAPERS*

“Group Talk” with Chris Li.

“Who Governs the Association” with Benjamin Egerod and Sebastian Thieme.

“Backlash Against Repression: Evidence from Refugees Fleeing the Former Soviet Bloc” with Valentin Bolotnyy and Mayya Komisarchik.

“Inequality in Administrative Democracy: Large-Sample Evidence from American Financial Regulation” with Daniel Carpenter, Devin Judge-Lord, Chris Kenny, Steve Rashin, Jacob Waggoner, and Susan Webb Yackee. *Winner, Herbert Kaufman Award for best paper presented at the 2021 APSA Annual Conference*.

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

EXTERNAL GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2022 - 2025 **National Science Foundation** – Unpacking Compound Treatments in Email Audit Experiments – \$403,882.

2025 - 2026 **Center for the Study of Democratic Politics** – Visiting Research Fellowship – \$104,000.

2025 - 2026 **Alexander von Humboldt Foundation** – Research Fellowship for Experienced Researchers – €25,600.

2024 **Stanford CASBS** – Fellowship to attend Summer Institute on Organizations and Their Effectiveness.

*Current links to all working papers available on author’s website

INTERNAL GRANTS AND RESEARCH SUPPORT

- 2024 - 2025 **Northwestern Undergraduate RA Program Committee** – \$3,250.
- 2024 **Institute for Policy Research** – Summer Undergraduate RA Award – \$6,300.
- 2024 **Northwestern University** – Dependent Care Professional Travel Grant – \$1,345.
- 2024 **Northwestern, Department of Political Science** – Farrell Fellowship Program – \$8,000.
- 2024 **Buffett Institute for Global Affairs** – Global Collaboration Grant – \$2,500.
- 2023 **Institute for Policy Research** – Graduate Student RA Award – \$41,736.
- 2023 **Institute for Policy Research** – Summer Undergraduate RA Award – \$5,950.
- 2023 **Northwestern, Department of Political Science** – Farrell Fellowship Program – \$7,500.
- 2016 - 2018 **Harvard Kennedy School** – Stone PhD Scholar in Inequality and Wealth Concentration.
- 2015 - 2016 **Harvard Law School** – Terence M. Considine Fellowship in Law and Economics.

AWARDS

- 2023 Emerging Scholar in American Political Economy, American Political Science Association.

PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCES

INVITED LECTURES

- 2026 **Princeton University, Department of Politics.** “Who Governs the Association?” Mar 26.
- 2025 **UC Berkeley, Department of Political Science.** “White Shoes, Hidden Hands.” Oct 23.
- 2025 **Princeton University, Department of Politics.** “White Shoes, Hidden Hands.” Feb 13.
- 2025 **Berkeley Law School.** “White Shoes, Hidden Hands.” Jan 15.
- 2024 **Emory University, Department of Political Science.** “White Shoes, Hidden Hands.” Feb 8.
- 2023 **Yale University, Department of Political Science.** “Lawyers as Lobbyists.” Feb 1.
- 2022 **University of Michigan Law School.** “Making Regulators Reasonable.” Mar 24.
- 2021 **Hebrew University, Department of Political Science.** “Making Regulators Reasonable.” Dec 15.
- 2021 **Tel Aviv University, Department of Political Science.** “Making Regulators Reasonable.” Dec 13.
- 2021 **Northwestern University, Department of Political Science.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Nov 2.
- 2020 **Georgetown University, Department of Government.** “Agency Failure and Individual Accountability.” Jan 24.
- 2020 **University of Texas, Austin, McCombs School of Business.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Jan 8.
- 2019 **Stanford University, Hoover Institution.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Dec 6.

- 2019 **Vanderbilt University, Department of Political Science.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Nov 13.
- 2019 **University of California, San Diego, School of Global Policy and Strategy.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Nov 6.
- 2019 **Harvard Law School.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Nov 5.
- 2019 **George Mason Law School.** “Agency Failure and Individual Accountability.” Sep 19.
- 2019 **Washington University in St. Louis, Department of Political Science.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Sep 17.
- 2019 **Berkeley Law School, Jurisprudence and Social Policy Program.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Feb 7.
- 2019 **Harvard Business School, Business Government and International Economy Unit.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Nov 5.
- 2019 **Administrative Conference of the United States.** “The Gains from Lobbying Financial Regulators.” Aug 9.
- 2018 **University of Texas, Austin, McCombs School of Business.** “What’s at Stake in Rulemaking? Financial Market Evidence for Banks’ Influence on Administrative Agencies.” Mar 23.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 **Princeton University.** “Conference on Identity and Inequality.” Apr 17.
- 2024 **UC Berkeley.** “American Political Economy Summer School.” May 22-May 24.
- 2023 **Stanford Law School.** “Conference on Regulatory Reform.” May 11.
- 2023 **Princeton University.** “Interest Group Workshop.” May 5.
- 2023 **Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference.** “Who Governs the Association.” Apr 14.
- 2023 **Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference.** “Grouptalk.” Apr 13.
- 2023 **University of South Carolina Law School.** “Access to Justice (A2J) Roundtable.” Mar 30.
- 2022 **Executive Politics at Michigan.** “Bureaucratic Information Acquisition.” Oct 24.
- 2022 **APSA Pre-Conference: Frontiers in Money in Politics Research.** “Grouptalk.” Sep 14.
- 2022 **Copenhagen Business School Money in Politics Conference.** “Ex Post Lobbying and the Dynamics of Legislative Attention.” Jun 16.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “The Politics of Place: Evidence from Refugees to the US.” Oct 2.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “Ex Post Lobbying and the Dynamics of Legislative Attention.” Oct 1.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “Participatory Inequality and Rulemaking: Evidence from Financial Regulation.” Sep 30.
- 2021 **American Political Economy Summer School.** “Lawyers as Lobbyists.” Jul 1.
- 2020 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “One Voice: The Role of Organization in Lobbying.” Sep 10.

- 2019 **Bureaucracy and Presidential Administration: Expertise and Accountability in Constitutional Government**, George Mason Law School. “Agency Failure and Individual Accountability.” Dec 6.
- 2019 **American Law and Economics Association (ALEA) Annual Conference**. “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” May 17.
- 2019 **Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) Annual Conference**. “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Jan 18.
- 2018 **Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference**. “What Public Comments During Rulemaking Do (and Why).” Apr 7.
- 2018 **Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference**. “The Price of Votes.” Apr 5.
- 2018 **Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) Annual Conference**. “What Public Comments During Rulemaking Do (and Why).” Jan 5.
- 2018 **Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) Annual Conference**. “Participation, Inequality, and Rational Responsiveness.” Jan 4.
- 2017 **Radcliffe Institute for Advanced Study**. “Lobbying with Lawyers: Financial Market Evidence for Banks’ Influence on Rulemaking.” Dec 8.
- 2017 **Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference**. “Equities and Inequities in Financial Rulemaking.” Apr 6.
- 2017 **University of Chicago Booth Business School**. “Lawyering and Lobbying: Why Banks Shape Rules.” Mar 4.
- 2015 **American Law and Economics Association (ALEA) Annual Meeting**. “Accident Liability in Imperfectly Competitive Markets.” May 16.

WORKSHOP PARTICIPATION

- 2025 **Institute for Social and Policy Studies, Yale University**. “American Political Economy: Foundations, Focuses, Frontiers.” Apr 25-Apr 26.
- 2024 **Center for Advanced Study in Behavior Sciences, Stanford University**. “Summer Institute on Organizations and their Effectiveness.” Jul 7-Jul 20.
- 2024 **Nuffield College, Oxford**. “The Politics of Citizenship, Central Banks, and Consumer Finance.” May 23-May 24.

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP ORGANIZING

- 2026 **Department of Political Science, Northwestern University**. “Workshop on Business Power and Politics.” Co-organizer. Oct 23.
- 2026 **Department of Political Science, Northwestern University**. “White Shoes Hidden Hands: Workshop.” Organizer. Jan 30.
- 2025 **Center for Study of Democratic Politics, Princeton University**. “White Shoes Hidden Hands: Workshop.” Organizer. Oct 3.
- 2025 **Institution for Social and Policy Study and the Law School, Yale University**. “Yale Conference on Politics and Law in the Administrative State.” Co-organizer. Jun 17-Jun 18.

OTHER CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

- 2026 **Center for Study of Democratic Politics, Princeton.** “Conference on Local Power and Political Economy.” Discussant. Mar 27.
- 2023 **Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference.** “Interest Groups in the American Context.” Discussant. Apr 14.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “Lobbyists and Lobbying, Strategies and Goals.” Discussant. Oct 3.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “Politics of Rulemaking in the Administrative State.” Discussant. Oct 1.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “Legislative Productivity in the US.” Chair and Discussant. Sep 29.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “Separation of Powers and Interbranch Relationships.” Chair and Discussant. Sep 30.
- 2021 **American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.** “Advances in Law Enforcement Policy Research.” Chair. Sep 30.

DEPARTMENTAL TALKS

- 2022 **Institute for Policy Research Colloquium, Northwestern University.** “Lawyers as Lobbyists: Regulatory Advocacy in American Finance.” Oct 10.
- 2020 **University of California, San Diego, School of Global Policy and Strategy Junior Faculty Brownbag.** “Does Electoral Politics Explain the Distribution of CDC Test Kits? Evidence from FOIA.” Oct 28.
- 2018 **Harvard University, Political Economy Workshop.** “Meetings, Comments, and the Distributive Politics of Administrative Policymaking.” Oct 29.
- 2018 **Harvard University, American Politics Research Workshop.** “What Public Comments During Rulemaking Do (and Why).” Feb 13.
- 2017 **Harvard University, Working Group in Political Psychology.** “Getting a Lawyer While Black: A Field Experiment.” Mar 10.
- 2017 **Harvard University, American Politics Research Workshop.** “Lawyering and Lobbying: Why Banks Shape Rules.” Feb 7.
- 2016 **Harvard University, Harvard Experiments Working Group.** “Getting a Lawyer While Black: A Field Experiment.” Sep 9.
- 2016 **Harvard Law School, Law and Economics Seminar.** “Getting a Lawyer While Black: A Field Experiment.” Mar 3.

ADVISING

GRADUATE ADVISING

Dissertation Committees

- 2025 Andrew Saab, Northwestern University
Postdoctoral Fellow, Center for Science of Science & Innovation, Northwestern University

Current Students

Joshua Corona, Northwestern University.
Arne Holverscheid, Northwestern University.
Alisher Juzgenbayev, Northwestern University.

UNDERGRADUATE ADVISING

Honors Theses

2026-2027 Mackenzie Tyson, Northwestern University.

Research Assistants

2025- Aldiyar Orazalin, Northwestern University.
2025- Jinhe Zhao, Northwestern University.
2024- Enzo Banal, Northwestern University.
2024- Neil Arora, Northwestern University.
2024- Jesse Chen, Northwestern University.
2023-2024 Mathieu Rojas Egoavil, Northwestern University.
2023-2024 Jamie Gall, Northwestern University.
2022-2023 Rick Brown, Northwestern University.
2022-2023 Kurtis Brian Nelson, Northwestern University.

Reading Courses

Winter 2025 Mathieu Rojas Egoavil, Northwestern University.

TEACHING

NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY

2026 Public Policy. Undergrad. (Fall).
2026 Money in Politics. Undergrad. (Fall).
2026 Access to Justice. Undergrad. (Fall).
2024 American Politics Field Seminar. Graduate. (Fall).
2024 Access to Justice. Undergrad. (Fall).
2024 Public Policy. Undergrad. (Fall).
2024 Access to Justice. Undergrad. (Spring).
2024 Public Policy. Undergrad. (Spring).
2022 R Workshop. Graduate.
2022 American Politics Field Seminar. Graduate. (Fall).
2022 Money in Politics. Undergrad. (Fall).

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA SAN DIEGO

2021 Policy Analysis and Social Welfare. MPP/MIA. (Fall).
2021 Law and Administration. MPP/MIA. (Fall).
2021 Law and Administration. MPP/MIA. (Spring).
2021 Bureaucratic Politics. MPP/MIA. (Spring).
2021 Interest Groups and the Policymaking Process. MPP/MIA. (Winter).

YALE UNIVERSITY

2019 American Mass Media: Law, Politics, and Policy. Undergrad. (Fall).
2019 Money in Politics. Undergrad. (Spring).

SERVICE

SERVICE TO THE FIELD

- 2024 Area Organizer, “Property, Environmental and Administrative Law”, American Law and Economics Association (ALEA).
2024 Program Director, Midwest Public Administration Caucus (MPAC), Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA).

DEPARTMENTAL SERVICE

Northwestern University

- 2022--2025 Co-organizer, American Politics Speaker Series.

University of California San Diego

- 2021--2022 Member, Law and Policy Ad Hoc Exploratory Committee.
2020--2022 Member, Admissions Committee.

Harvard University

- 2015--2017 Graduate Student Coordinator, Undergraduate Research Scholars Program, Institute for Quantitative Social Science.

ACADEMIC PEER REVIEW

American Political Science Review, Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory, Journal of Politics, American Journal of Political Science, Politics & Gender, Regulation & Governance, Israeli Science Foundation (ISF).